David Almona

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Early-career analytics professional with experience in statistical modeling, machine learning, and sports analytics. Experienced in building predictive models, analyzing large datasets, and communicating findings to support data-driven decisions.

EDUCATION

Centre College **2022 – May 2026**

Bachelor of Science in Economics (Major), Data Science (Minor), *cum laude* *Danville, KY*

- **Relevant Coursework:** Applied Machine Learning, Statistical Modeling, Econometrics, Modern Calculus I, Data Visualization
- **Leadership & Activities:** Track and Field Student-Athlete | Resident Assistant | Co-President: Centre Brother-to-Brother Club

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL, Stata | **Data Visualization**: Tableau, Power BI, Excel | **Tools:** Git/GitHub, Jupyter Notebook

EXPERIENCE

Basketball Analytics Intern **Feb 2026 – Sep 2026**

Los Angeles Sparks *Remote*

- Built statistical player comparison frameworks that inform roster and game strategy decisions for the coaching and front office staff
- Maintained and expanded internal analytics databases, improving data reliability for downstream decision making
- Delivered game-by-game, seasonal, and player evaluation reports that shaped how staff track performance trends league-wide

Business Program Development Fellow **Sep 2025 – Dec 2025**

Sustainable Business Network (SBN) of Massachusetts *Cambridge, MA*

- Built the Technical Assistance Pilot Program from scratch, creating SBN's first structured path connecting micro-entrepreneurs to affordable consulting
- Designed multi-step intake process including dual Google Forms (20+ questions each), interview framework, a contact tracking sheet, and a memorandum of understanding template
- Launched the pilot and began consultant intake with food businesses, then documented the full process for handoff to the next intern

Undergraduate Sports Analytics Research Fellow **Jun 2025 – Jul 2025**

Carnegie Mellon University - Statistics & Data Science | *Capstone Project* *Pittsburgh, PA*

- 1 of 16 students selected for a fully funded 8-week research program
- Trained and compared five models (including XGBoost) to predict forced turnovers within 5 seconds of a press, using 252,646 tracked pressing sequences from 502 MLS matches and 10Hz player tracking data from SkillCorner
- Oral presentation at the Carnegie Mellon Sports Analytics Conference 2025 & American Soccer Insights Summit 2026

Data Analytics Extern **Mar 2025 – Jun 2025**

Beats by Dr. Dre, via Extern | *Capstone Project* *Remote*

- Conducted market research by analyzing 4,500+ consumer survey responses and scraped product reviews using Python (Pandas, NumPy, TextBlob) to identify market opportunities and feature preferences for a wireless speaker product launch
- Delivered strategic assessment recommending $150-250 price point based on consumer insights, demographic segmentation, and sentiment analysis

PROJECTS

2026 FIFA World Cup Prediction | Personal Project | *R & Python* **Jun 2026**

- Projected tournament outcomes using a Poisson regression model and Monte Carlo simulations
- Finished 4th of 47 entries in a public prediction contest on X (fka. Twitter), ranking 2nd by Brier score

Loan Default Prediction | Applied Machine Learning Course Project | *Python* **Mar 2026**

- Modeled loan default risk on 307K Home Credit applicants, comparing 6 ML algorithms with 5-fold cross-validation
- Tuned decision threshold via F2 score to prioritize recall, reducing costly false negatives for the lender

National Olympic Performance: Determinants of Medal Counts | Econometrics | *Stata* **Sep 2024 – Dec 2024**

- Analyzed how economic, demographic, and historical factors relate to national medal counts across multiple Summer Olympics
- Built and compared panel regression models with country fixed effects to address unobserved heterogeneity and model specification issues

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Mentee, WeStutter@Work Mentorship Program • Mentee, 2026 NFL Big Data Bowl Mentorship Program • Selected Participant, Philadelphia Eagles Virtual Development Series (Business Operations)